

COVER / PAGE MAP

## Page Allocation

184 pages · one recipe per spread · pencil section name on each first blank page

| Section                 | Now | Blank spr. | Pages      |
|-------------------------|-----|------------|------------|
| Sauces & Salsas         | 4   | 6          | 20         |
| Marinades & Rubs        | 3   | 6          | 18         |
| Salads                  | 3   | 5          | 16         |
| Soups & Stews           | 1   | 4          | 10         |
| Sandwiches & Tacos      | 1   | 3          | 8          |
| Pasta & Noodles         | 1   | 3          | 8          |
| Entrées (all proteins)  | 2   | 8          | 20         |
| Sides                   | 1   | 4          | 10         |
| Breakfast               | 1   | 3          | 8          |
| Baking & Desserts       | –   | 4          | 8          |
| Drinks                  | –   | 3          | 6          |
| Appetizers & Preserves  | –   | 3          | 6          |
| <b>Allocated</b>        |     |            | <b>138</b> |
| <b>Overflow at back</b> |     |            | <b>~46</b> |

### Notes

- Entrées runs widest — five proteins share it.
- Hidden Gluten card: inside front cover (no page cost).
- Mark section page ranges in the TOC before gluing.
- Overflow serves whichever section outgrows its guess.

COVER / INDEX

## The Sharp Edge

Glue-in order & section map · print run 2 · 18 recipes

### GLUE-IN ORDER (LEAVE 2–3 BLANK SPREADS AFTER EACH SECTION)

1. SAUCES & SALSAS — Mango Salsa · Cucumber Dressing · Raspberry Vinaigrette · Bourbon Butter
2. MARINADES — Flank Quick v1 · Flank Overnight v2 · Souvlaki
3. SALADS — Thai-Japanese Cucumber · Gürkensalat · Watermelon-Feta-Mint
4. SOUPS & STEWS — GF Goulash
5. SANDWICHES & TACOS — Tequila Lime Chicken
6. PASTA — Family Spaghetti Sauce (2009)
7. ENTRÉES — Salmon w/ Mango Salsa · Flank Stir-Fry
8. SIDES — Celeriac Purée
9. BREAKFAST — Fluffy Pancakes
10. REFERENCE — Hidden Gluten (inside front cover)

### NOTEBOOK WORKFLOW

- Number pages first; log each glued recipe in the printed TOC.
- Glue-stick or adhesive roller only — liquid glue wrinkles the paper.
- Hinge-glue (top edge only) to keep the page under free for version notes.
- Pending: spaghetti-sauce herbs · broccoli slaw quantities · vișină quantities.

SAUCES & SALSAS

## Mango Salsa

*About 2 cups · salmon, seafood, chicken, tacos, chips*

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 ripe mango, peeled and diced
- 1/4 red onion, finely diced
- 1/2 red bell pepper, finely diced
- 1 small jalapeño, seeded, minced (opt.)
- 2 tbsp cilantro, chopped
- 1 tbsp mint, chopped (opt.)
- Juice of 1 lime
- 1 tsp honey or maple syrup (opt.)
- 1/4 tsp kosher salt · black pepper

### METHOD

1. Combine mango, onion, pepper, jalapeño, cilantro, mint.
2. Add lime juice, honey, salt, pepper.
3. Toss gently so the mango keeps its shape.
4. Rest 10–15 min; adjust lime/salt.

### NOTES

- *Best within a few hours of making.*
- *Add cucumber for crunch; avocado (just before serving) for richness.*

SAUCES & SALSAS

## Thai-Japanese Cucumber Dressing

*Enough for 2 large cucumbers*

### INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp tamari or soy sauce
- 1 1/2 tbsp rice vinegar
- 2 tsp sesame oil
- 1 tsp wasabi oil
- 1 tsp honey or maple syrup
- 1 tsp grated ginger
- 1 small garlic clove, grated
- 1 tsp lime juice
- 1/2 tsp chili crisp (opt.)
- 1 tsp toasted sesame seeds

### METHOD

1. Whisk everything except chili crisp and seeds.
2. Taste before adding chili crisp — salty, bright, lightly sweet, not hot.
3. Add sesame seeds just before tossing.

### NOTES

- *GF tamari for celiac guests.*
- *Wasabi oil varies — start at 1/2 tsp if pungent.*
- *Also good on cold noodles, slaw, grilled salmon.*

SAUCES & SALSAS

## Raspberry Vinaigrette

*For chilled chicken, goat cheese & raspberry salad*

### INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp raspberry jam (or 1/3 cup fresh, mashed/strained)
- 1/4 cup olive oil
- 2 tbsp white wine or balsamic vinegar
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- 1 tsp honey
- Salt & pepper

### METHOD

1. Whisk (or shake in a jar) until emulsified.
2. Adjust honey/vinegar — echo the berries, don't drown the goat cheese.

### SALAD BUILD

- Chilled chicken, goat cheese, raspberries, candied pecans/walnuts, thin red onion, spinach or arugula.
- Lighter alternates: honey-balsamic, poppy seed, lemon-honey.

SAUCES & SALSAS

## Bourbon-Shallot Seafood Butter

*One ~250 g log (12 coins) · chargrilled oysters & lobster · GF*

### INGREDIENTS

- 250 g unsalted butter, softened · 3 tbsp bourbon
- 1 shallot, minced fine · 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tsp maple syrup · zest of 1 lemon + 1 tsp juice
- 1 tsp GF Worcestershire · 1/2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1/4 tsp cayenne · 2 tbsp chives · 1 tbsp parsley
- 3/4 tsp kosher salt · 1/4 tsp black pepper

### METHOD

1. Sweat shallot + garlic in 1 tbsp of the butter, 2–3 min, no browning. Add bourbon + maple; reduce to a syrupy tablespoon.
2. Cool the reduction completely — warm splits the log.
3. Beat remaining butter creamy; add reduction + everything else. Taste salt against your oysters' brine.
4. Roll into a 4 cm log in parchment; chill 2+ hrs.

### DEPLOY

- Oysters: coin per shell, hot grill 4–5 min until liquor bubbles.
- Lobster: coins under split shell, or melt as dipping butter.
- Raw oysters get nothing — butter the grilled bread instead.
- Fridge 1 wk · freezer 3 mo (slice frozen). Wheated bourbons pair best.

MARINADES

## Flank Steak Marinade — Quick

4–8 hr · coats 5–6 lb flank (feeds ~15) · v1

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup soy sauce (tamari for GF)
- 3/4 cup olive oil
- 3/4 cup brown sugar, packed
- 6 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 3 tbsp Worcestershire
- 12 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp grated ginger (opt.)
- 6 green onions, sliced (opt.)

### METHOD

1. Whisk until sugar dissolves.
2. Split steak + marinade across 2 zip bags.
3. Fridge 4–8 hrs. Don't exceed ~12.
4. Grill hot & fast; rest; slice thin against the grain.

### NOTES

- GF: tamari + check Worcestershire (Lea & Perrins Canada is GF).
- No Dijon. For overnight soaks use v2 (next card).

MARINADES

## Flank Steak Marinade — Overnight

12–18 hr · coats 5–6 lb flank (feeds ~15) · v2

### INGREDIENTS

- 1/2 cup soy sauce (tamari for GF)
- 3/4 cup olive oil
- 1/2 cup brown sugar, packed
- 3 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 2 tbsp Worcestershire
- 10 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 1/2 tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp grated ginger
- 6 green onions, sliced

### METHOD

1. Whisk until sugar dissolves.
2. 2 zip bags, air pressed out, turn to coat. Fridge 12–18 hrs.
3. Pull steaks 30–45 min ahead; pat dry so they sear, not steam.
4. High direct heat, 4–5 min/side to 54–57°C (med-rare), in batches.
5. Rest 8–10 min; slice thin against the grain at an angle.

### NOTES

- Less salt/acid + more oil than v1 so the surface doesn't over-cure.

## MARINADES

### Chicken Souvlaki Marinade

*For 5 lb boneless skinless thighs (feeds ~15)*

#### INGREDIENTS

- 1/2 cup olive oil
- Juice of 4 lemons
- 6 garlic cloves, minced
- 3 tbsp dried oregano
- 2 tsp salt · 1 tsp pepper

#### METHOD

1. Whisk; coat chicken.
2. Fridge overnight (min. 2 hrs).
3. Skewers or grill whole.

#### NOTES

— *Naturally GF — everything mixed from oil/citrus/herbs is safe by default.*

## SALADS

### Thai-Japanese Cucumber Salad

*Serves 4 as a side · 15 min + draining*

#### INGREDIENTS

- 2 large English cucumbers · 1/2 tsp kosher salt
- 2 tbsp tamari or soy · 1 1/2 tbsp rice vinegar
- 2 tsp sesame oil · 1 tsp wasabi oil
- 1 tsp honey/maple · 1 tsp grated ginger
- 1 small garlic clove, grated · 1 tsp lime juice
- 2 tbsp each cilantro & mint, chopped
- 2 green onions, sliced · 1 tsp sesame seeds
- 1/2 tsp chili crisp (opt.)

#### METHOD

1. Slice thin — or lightly smash and cut irregular pieces.
2. Toss with salt; drain in colander 15–20 min; pat dry.
3. Whisk tamari, vinegar, oils, honey, ginger, garlic, lime.
4. Add cucumbers, herbs, green onions; toss.
5. Finish with seeds and chili crisp. Serve now or chill ≤30 min.

#### ADD-INS

— *Peanuts/cashews, radish, carrot, edamame, crispy shallots, avocado.*

SALADS

## German Creamy Cucumber-Dill Salad

*Gurkensalat · serves 6 · BBQ side · GF*

### INGREDIENTS

- 2 large English cucumbers · 1 tsp kosher salt (draining)
- 1/2 cup sour cream (full fat) · 1/4 cup Greek yogurt
- 1 small garlic clove, finely grated
- 3 tbsp fresh dill, chopped
- 1 tbsp white wine vinegar or lemon juice (opt.)
- 1/2 tsp sugar (opt., traditional) · 1/4 tsp pepper + salt to taste

### METHOD

1. Shave into thin 2–3 mm rounds.
2. Toss with salt; drain 20–30 min; squeeze gently, discard liquid.
3. Stir dressing; season lightly — cucumbers bring salt from draining.
4. Fold in; chill 30–60 min; serve within a few hours. Extra dill on top.

### NOTES

- 2:1 sour cream to yogurt = light but still rich; all sour cream for old-school.
- Dairy in summer — shade or a bowl of ice outdoors.

SALADS

## Watermelon-Feta-Mint Salad

*Serves ~15 as a side · assemble day-of only*

### INGREDIENTS

- 1 large watermelon (10–12 lb), cubed
- 1.5–2 lb block feta in brine (block > pre-crumbled)
- 1 large bunch mint, leaves torn
- Juice of 2–3 limes · light drizzle olive oil
- Flaky salt & black pepper

### METHOD

1. Cube the watermelon; chill.
2. Just before serving: combine with feta and mint.
3. Lime juice, drizzle of oil, salt, pepper. Toss gently.

### NOTES

- *Cut watermelon weeps — never assemble ahead.*
- *Naturally gluten-free.*

## SOUPS & STEWS

### GF Hungarian Beef Goulash

*Serves 6 · potato-thickened, no flour/roux*

#### INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb beef chuck, 1-inch cubes · 3 tbsp oil or lard
- 3 yellow onions, diced · 4 garlic cloves, minced
- 3 tbsp sweet Hungarian paprika (GF)
- 1 tsp smoked or hot paprika · 1 tsp caraway, crushed
- 2 tbsp tomato paste · 2 red bell peppers, diced
- 3 cups beef broth (GF) · 2 bay leaves
- 1 1/2 lb Yukon Golds, cubed
- 1 1/2 tsp salt · 1/2 tsp pepper

#### METHOD

1. Pat beef dry, season; brown in batches in a Dutch oven, ~8 min. Set aside.
2. Medium heat: onions until golden, ~10 min. Garlic 1 min.
3. OFF the heat: stir in paprikas, caraway, tomato paste ~30 sec (scorched paprika = bitter).
4. Return beef + juices; add peppers, broth, bays. Cover, low simmer ~90 min to fork-tender.
5. Add potatoes; simmer uncovered ~30 min until broth thickens.
6. Discard bays; season; rest 10 min.

#### NOTES

- *Hidden gluten: paprika, broth/bouillon, tomato paste — check labels.*
- *Thicker: mash a few potato cubes against the pot.*
- *Sour cream on top. Better next day; freezes 3 mo.*

## SANDWICHES & TACOS

### Tequila Lime Chicken — Tacos or Club

*Serves 4 · tacos or club · source: food.com #493784*

#### MARINADE

- 1/4 cup tequila · 1/2 cup lime juice · 1 tsp lime zest
- 2 tbsp olive oil · 1 jalapeño · 2 garlic cloves
- 1/4 cup cilantro, leaves + tender stems
- 1 tsp ancho or chipotle powder · 1 tsp cumin
- 4 chicken breasts (~4 oz), flattened · salt + pepper at the grill

#### METHOD

1. Blitz everything except chicken, salt, pepper until smooth.
2. Bag + massage. Marinate 4 hrs—overnight, no longer — the lime turns the surface mealy.
3. Grill med-high, oiled grates, seasoned: ~5–7 min per side.

#### TACO BUILD (HOUSE)

- *Corn tortillas (100% corn = GF) · guac · mango salsa (on file) · queso fresco · cilantro · lime.*
- *Club (original): toasted bun, chipotle mayo, lettuce, tomato, crisp bacon, guac, queso.*
- *Marinade also works over burrito bowls and salads.*

## PASTA

### Family Spaghetti Sauce (2009)

*Big batch · freezes well*

#### INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb ground beef (extra lean)
- 3–4 celery sticks · 2 peppers, red + green
- Garlic · tomato paste
- 1 can diced tomatoes · 1 can tomato juice
- 2 cans spaghetti sauce
- Herbs — incl. marjoram

#### METHOD

1. Brown the beef; drain if needed.
2. Celery + peppers 5–8 min; garlic the last minute.
3. Tomato paste; 1–2 min to darken.
4. Diced tomatoes, juice, both cans of sauce.
5. Marjoram, oregano, basil, bay, salt, pepper.
6. Simmer low, partly covered, 1–2+ hrs.

#### NOTES

- *Herb quantities and method to confirm against the paper original.*
- *Freezes well.*

## ENTRÉES

### Salmon with Mango Salsa

*Serves 4 · 15 min prep · 10–14 min cook*

#### SALMON

- 4 fillets, 170–200 g each · 1 tbsp avocado/olive oil
- 1 tsp kosher salt · 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1/2 tsp cumin · 1/2 tsp garlic powder
- 1/4 tsp black pepper · zest of 1 lime

#### SALSA

- 1 mango, diced · 1/4 red onion · 1/2 red pepper
- 1 jalapeño (opt.) · 2 tbsp cilantro · juice of 1 lime · 1/4 tsp salt

#### OVEN METHOD

1. Heat oven to 220°C / 425°F.
2. Pat dry, skin-down on lined sheet; rub with oil; season with spice mix + zest.
3. Bake 10–14 min until centre flakes but stays moist.
4. Mix salsa while it cooks. Rest fish 2 min; top generously.

#### GRILL METHOD

- *Med-high, oiled grates: skin-down 5–7 min, flip 2–4 min, salsa off-grill.*
- *Sides: coconut or cilantro-lime rice, asparagus, cucumber salad.*

## ENTRÉES

### Flank Steak Stir-Fry

Serves 3–4 (1 lb; tested at 800 g — sear in batches) · black bean–hoisin

#### VELVETING MARINADE

- 1 lb flank, sliced thin against the grain
- 1 tbsp tamari · 1 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 tsp neutral oil · 1/2 tsp baking soda (opt.)

#### SAUCE

- 1 tbsp black bean sauce · 1 1/2 tbsp hoisin
- 3 tbsp water · 2 garlic cloves · 1 tsp ginger, minced

#### EVERYTHING ELSE

- 1/3 cup cashews · 2–3 cups cooked/leftover veg
- Jasmine rice (microwave 10 min works)
- Finish: sesame oil off heat · chili crisp at table

#### METHOD

1. Toss steak with marinade; rest 20–30 min.
2. Meanwhile: mix sauce; start rice at the 10-min-left mark.
3. Toast cashews in dry pan 2–3 min; remove.
4. Hot oiled pan: sear steak 1–2 min; remove.
5. Same pan: warm the veg 1–2 min.
6. Everything back in + sauce; toss 1 min to glaze. Serve over rice.

#### NOTES

- *Wine:* Zinfandel (or Grenache). Avoid Cab Sauv with soy sauces.
- *Premium sesame oil is finishing-only — never cook with it.*

## SIDE DISHES

### Celeriac Purée, Infused Milk & Cream

Serves 4 · naturally GF · pairs with steak

#### INGREDIENTS

- 900 g celeriac, peeled, 2 cm cubes
- 500 ml whole milk · 120 ml heavy cream
- 3 garlic cloves, crushed · 3 thyme sprigs · 1 bay leaf
- 1/2 tsp black peppercorns · 50 g cold butter
- 1 tsp salt · pinch fresh nutmeg

#### METHOD

1. Milk, cream + aromatics to a bare simmer; off heat; steep ~15 min. Never boil hard.
2. Add celeriac (aromatics in); gentle simmer ~20 min to fully fork-tender.
3. Celeriac into blender; strain & keep all the liquid; discard aromatics.
4. Blend with cold butter, adding liquid a splash at a time until glossy. Sieve for velvet.
5. Salt, nutmeg, taste, serve warm.

#### NOTES

- *Cooking IN the infused milk is the whole trick — seasons from inside.*
- *Less liquid = pipeable; more = spoonable. Rich — keep the plate light.*

## BREAKFAST

# Classic Fluffy Pancakes

~10 medium · serves 3–4

## INGREDIENTS

- 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour · 3 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1 tbsp sugar · 1/2 tsp kosher salt
- 1 1/4 cups milk · 1 large egg
- 3 tbsp melted butter (+ more for pan) · 1 tsp vanilla

## METHOD

1. Whisk dry ingredients.
2. Whisk milk, egg, butter, vanilla in a second bowl.
3. Combine; stir only until no dry patches — lumps are good.
4. Rest batter 5–10 min.
5. Buttered skillet, medium heat; 1/4 cup per pancake.
6. Flip when bubbles form and edges look dry (~2 min); 1–2 min more.

## ADD AFTER POURING

- Blueberries · banana · chocolate chips · pecans · cinnamon · lemon zest.
- Serve: maple + salted butter · berries + cream · PB + banana · apple compote.

## REFERENCE

# Reference: Hidden Gluten

Celiac watch-outs · kitchen & grill

## AT THE GRILL

- Shared grates: scrub hot or use foil if gluten food was cooked on them.
- Bottled sauces: coleslaw dressing, Worcestershire (barley malt), regular soy, many BBQ sauces.
- Anything self-mixed from oil/citrus/herbs is safe by default.
- Separate serving utensils — no double-dipping into GF dishes.

## PANTRY CHECKPOINTS

- Paprika: cheap blends may use wheat anti-caking filler.
- Beef broth / bouillon: common hidden source.
- Tomato paste: rarely, but glance at it.
- Soy sauce has wheat — use GF tamari.
- Wasabi oil: usually GF but formulations vary — check for wheat/barley/malt/soy sauce.